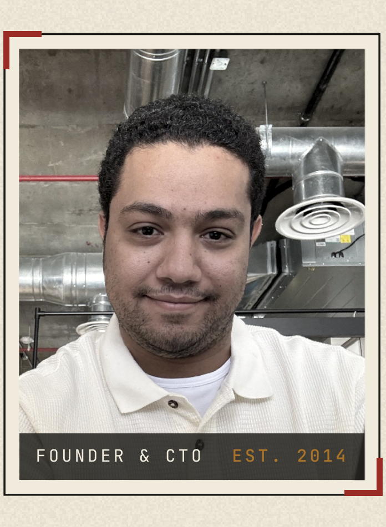
NO. 18 · VOL. ZERO TO ONE CURRICULUM VITÆ — THE FOUNDER'S RECORD EST. MMXIV

Ahmad Abdul-Jawad *Mahmoud*


FOUNDER & CTO EST. 2014

FOUNDER & CTO, BURAQ / FOUNDING ENGINEER / TECHNICAL LEAD

CAIRO → RIYADH · BUILDS THE COMPANY AND ITS FIRST VERSION

CORRESPONDENCE
ahmad_abdulgawad.mahmoud@yahoo.com

TELEPHONE
+20 112 687 3152 · +966 507 242 916

BUREAU
Cairo, Egypt

WIRE
LinkedIn — /ahmadabdulgawadmahmoud

● SEE THE LIVE INTERACTIVE EDITION ↗

◆ BURAQ — BURAQEGYPT.COM ↗

I founded **Buraq** and built it myself. Since March 2026 I have been Founder & CTO of an Egyptian ride-hailing platform (buraqegypt.com): a NestJS / PostgreSQL / Redis backend, a 29-screen operations console, rider and captain apps on iOS and Android, and the public web app now live — **3,100+ commits across nine repositories**, every one of them mine. Around the code I formed the company, priced the product from 626 observed competitor fares, and wrote the business model and go-live plan. Before that I spent **12+ years** in iOS and **seven of them leading** the team behind a POS platform used by 20k+ restaurants — so I build for the day the second engineer arrives.

12+	9	10k+	20k+
YEARS IN ENGINEERING	REPOS BUILT BY ONE AUTHOR	AUTOMATED TESTS ACROSS THE PLATFORM	BUSINESSES SERVED BY THE POS I LED

§ 01 Zero to One

01 — SHIP FROM NOTHING

Empty repo to launch-ready platform

I take the first version all the way myself — data model, API contract, auth, the deploy. At Buraq that is a **22-module** backend (**trip state machine**, **scored dispatch** over a Redis geo index, **double-entry ledger**, five realtime gateways, **330+ endpoints**, **2,900+ tests**), then every client that sits on it — before anyone else touched the code.

02 — FOUND THE COMPANY

Decide what nobody else can decide

Nobody to escalate to when you are the founder and the whole engineering team. At Buraq I formed the company, mapped the Law 87/2018 ride-hailing licence, and set the fares from a **626-ride field study** of Cairo's incumbents (23 fitted rate cards) — a 20% commission, a long-trip taper and minimums under every competitor's — each decision run through the business model **before it shipped as a migration**.

03 — STANDARDS BEFORE SCALE

Build it so a team can take it over

Idempotent mutations, acyclic module boundaries, migrations as the only way the schema changes, a CI suite that gates the merge, Swagger docs, and a shared core package versioned and pinned by every client — written while I was still the only engineer. That is the difference between a prototype and something you can **hire into**.

04 — THEN LEAD THE TEAM

I have done the other half too

Seven years leading a **5+ engineer iOS team** — onboarding, mentoring, review culture, CI/CD, a **99.8–99.9% crash-free** rate in production. I know what founding code has to look like by the time the second engineer arrives, because I have been on the receiving end of it.

§ 02 Professional Experience

Mar 2026 — Present
CURRENT
CAIRO · FOUNDER

Founder & CTO — Backend · Web · iOS · Android

Buraq — buraqegypt.com ↗ · Buraq Technologies

Founded an Egyptian ride-hailing platform and have carried its **entire technical scope alone**: chose the stack, set the standards, and built nine repositories from empty — a hardened backend and operations console, rider and captain apps on **iOS and Android**, a shared core package per platform, and the public web app **live at buraqegypt.com**. Every layer governed by explicit rules: idempotent mutations, double-entry accounting, acyclic module boundaries, and a CI suite that gates the merge. Now preparing a cash-only lean beta in Cairo.

Backend API
NestJS · TypeScript · Mar '26 → now

Modular monolith, **22 modules** in an acyclic graph — **trip state machine**, **scored waterfall dispatch** over a Redis geo index, admin-tunable pricing across six ride tiers, **double-entry ledger** with cash and card settlement (Paymob, Fawry), scheduled and multi-stop rides, five realtime **Socket.IO gateways**, OTP / Apple / Google auth with RBAC, idempotency and audit log · **330+ endpoints** over 55 controllers, 62 entities, **2,900+ tests**, Swagger docs.

Ops Console
Next.js 14 · Jul '26 → now

29-screen ops surface — live **MapLibre** trips map with demand heatmap, dispatch and SOS boards, KYC review, finance reconciliation, refunds and payouts, cash control, map **zone editor**, feature flags, audit log, **Google SSO** · English and Arabic, 170+ tests.

iOS · Rider & Captain
SwiftUI · Swift 6 · Jul '26 → now

Two native **SwiftUI** apps on a shared **BuraqCore** package (domain · networking · design system, version-pinned) — the full **trip lifecycle** on live GPS, Socket.IO feeds with fresh-token reconnect, chat, wallet and payments, **Live Activities**, Siri voice booking, on-device ID verification, captain earnings and navigation · ~240 views, **1,000+ tests**, strict concurrency.

Android · Captain
Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Aug '26 → now

Native port against **the same API contract** — 18 feature modules on convention plugins, Hilt, a pure-Kotlin domain; onboarding, the shift's foreground service and the trip end to end running against the backend · **1,500+ tests**.

Android · Rider
Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Sep '26 → now

Screen-by-screen parity port of the iOS rider app — 11 feature modules on a published **buraq-core-android** (GitHub Packages) · **2,200+ tests**, including 371 screenshot goldens in light, dark and RTL.

Web · buraqegypt.com
Next.js 16 · React 19 · Oct '26 → now

Marketing site, **rider web app** with live trip tracking, **captain onboarding portal** with on-device document OCR, public trip-share pages and app links · English and Arabic (RTL), WCAG 2.2 AA, **1,800+ tests** · **live on Render since 15 Oct 2026**.

One backend · one contract · six client surfaces — and the company around them: incorporation, the Law 87/2018 licence path, a pricing engine fitted to 626 observed fares, the business model and investor materials, the go-live plan. 3,100+ commits, one author — so I know exactly what I will be asking of the team I hire.

Aug 2019 — Aug 2026
RIYADH, KSA

iOS Team Lead – 7 years leading the iOS org

Marn — Jahez Group ↗

- **Led a 5+ engineer iOS team** for seven years — onboarding, mentoring, career growth, and the review culture behind an enterprise POS used by 20k+ restaurants and cafés.
- **Owned the technical roadmap and architecture:** an offline-first CoreData core with cloud sync, built so a venue keeps trading when the network does not.
- **Set the engineering standards** — module boundaries, code review, automated testing — that held the app at a 99.8–99.9% crash-free rate in production.
- **Drove the multi-year migration** to SwiftUI, Combine and async/await without pausing feature delivery, and made the case for it to product leadership.
- **Built CI/CD and the release process from scratch**, cutting deployment time 60% and shortening every engineer's feedback loop.
- Ran the performance programme (40% faster load times) and designed the table-management, order-processing and inventory systems at the heart of the product.
- Partnered with product, design and backend leadership on scope, estimates and delivery commitments the team could keep.

Dec 2025 — Jun 2026
VOLUNTEER

Senior iOS Engineer

HaramBlur ↗ · Voluntary Charity Project

- Designed an architecture integrating on-device machine learning for real-time content analysis.
- Built a seamless communication layer between native iOS and web-based content.
- Implemented efficient image processing with region-based and full-image blur effects.
- Created a real-time video monitoring system for continuous content filtering.
- Developed smart banner blocking and optimised memory management throughout.

Mar 2018 — May 2019
RIYADH, KSA

iOS Team Lead

Ego — The Ride Hailing App ↗

- Led iOS delivery for a complete ride-hailing ecosystem (rider, driver, watchOS) serving 15M+ users in Saudi Arabia.
- Implemented real-time GPS tracking and navigation with MapKit and optimised route algorithms.
- Integrated Apple Pay, HyperPay, and push-notification infrastructure.
- Created seamless iPhone ⟷ Apple Watch handoff for continuous ride tracking.
- Built the driver rating system and real-time fare calculation engine.

Sep 2016 — Mar 2018
KSA

Senior iOS Engineer

HungerStation — DeliveryHero Group ↗

- Contributed to a major food-delivery platform serving 20M+ users.
- Optimised app performance for high-volume transaction processing.
- Implemented real-time order tracking and delivery optimisation.
- Collaborated with backend teams on API design and integration.

May 2016 — Aug 2016

iOS Developer

ALNapedh ↗

- Developed food-ordering apps with Firebase integration and real-time features.
- Implemented Spreedly payments and live-chat functionality.
- Built responsive UI with Auto Layout across multiple device sizes.

Jul 2015 — Sep 2015

iOS & Apple Watch Developer

Nile Design Co. ↗

- Early adopter of Apple Watch development (watchOS 1–2).
- Built a foundation in iOS and watchOS app development.
- Adopted SwiftUI from WWDC 2019 onward.

May 2014 — May 2015

iOS Developer

UK Pro. Solutions Ltd. ↗

- Foundation iOS experience in Objective-C and early Swift.
- Built social networks and e-commerce platforms.
- Learned core iOS principles and App Store deployment.

§ 03 Selected Projects

01 — FULL-STACK

Buraq — Ride-Hailing (founded Mar 2026)

NestJS · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Redis · Socket.IO · Next.js · SwiftUI · Kotlin · Jetpack Compose

Egyptian ride-hailing platform I founded and built solo: a hardened NestJS backend (trip state machine, scored dispatch, double-entry ledger, five realtime gateways, 2,900+ tests), a 29-screen ops console, rider and captain apps on **iOS and Android**, and the public web app **live at buraqegypt.com**.

◆ Founder & CTO · Nine Repos · 10k+ Tests

02 — ENTERPRISE

Marn — iPad POS

SwiftUI · CoreData · CloudKit · Real-time Sync

Enterprise point-of-sale serving 20k+ restaurants and cafés across Saudi Arabia. Offline-first architecture, complex table management, real-time order processing — **the product my iOS team owned for seven years**.

★ 4.8 / 5 — 2,437 ratings

03 — MOBILITY

Ego — Ride Hailing

MapKit · Core Location · Apple Pay · Push · watchOS

Complete ride-hailing ecosystem: rider app, driver app, and Apple Watch companion. Real-time GPS, Apple Pay, and cross-device experiences for 15M+ users.

★ 4.7 / 5 — 211.8k+ ratings

04 — DELIVERY

HungerStation

UIKit · Firebase · Real-time APIs · Perf Optimization

Major food-delivery platform serving 20M+ users across Saudi Arabia and Bahrain. Focused on performance and real-time order tracking.

★ 4.5 / 5 — 1.9M+ ratings

05 — AI / PRIVACY

HaramBlur — Privacy Browser

SwiftUI · CoreML · WKWebView · CoreImage · Vision

Privacy-focused iOS browser with real-time, AI-powered content detection and filtering. On-device ML, smart blur effects, and live video monitoring.

◆ AI-Powered Privacy Browser

06 — COMMUNITY

Daleelo

MapKit · Core Location · Social SDKs · Community

Muslim community app for users across the US — prayer times, mosque finder, and community features with enhanced location and social integration.

★ 4.5 / 5 — 1,287 ratings

§ 04 Stack & Craft

ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP ORG

Team Leadership · Technical Direction · Architecture Governance · Technical Roadmap · Mentoring & Career Growth · Onboarding · Code Review Culture · Estimation & Planning · Cross-functional Partnership · Quality & Crash Budgets · Release Management · Agile / Scrum

FOUNDER COMPANY

Company Formation · Pricing & Unit Economics · Business Modelling · Investor Materials · Ride-Hailing Licensing · Payments Vendors · Go-to-Market

IOS — 2025 CORE

Swift 6.0 · SwiftUI · UIKit · Combine · async/await · SwiftData · iOS 18+

ANDROID — 2025 NATIVE

Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Coroutines · Flow · MVVM

ARCHITECTURE PATTERNS

MVVM · VIPER · Clean Architecture · Coordinator · TDD

APPLE ECOSYSTEM PLATFORMS

watchOS · tvOS · macOS · WidgetKit · Live Activities · App Intents

MODERN FEATURES INTELLIGENCE

Core ML · Vision · ARKit · Dynamic Island · App Tracking

BACKEND & APIS FULL-STACK

NestJS · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · TypeORM · Redis · JWT/OTP Auth · REST · GraphQL · Firebase · CloudKit · Socket.IO · Swagger/OpenAPI · Docker

WEB FULL-STACK

Next.js 16 · React 19 · Tailwind · MapLibre · Vitest · Playwright · i18n / RTL

TOOLING & AI WORKFLOW

Xcode 15+ · Fastlane · TestFlight · Instruments · Git · Claude Code · Copilot · Cursor

§ 05 Portfolio Index

FOOD & GAMING
HungerStation — delivery
Punters — racing tips

TRANSPORTATION
Buraq — founder
Ego — Rider
Ego — Driver
Ego — Watch app

ENTERPRISE
Marn POS
Medical Guide

SOCIAL & COMMUNITY
Daleelo
NU-inc
VeeU

WATCHOS
Ego Watch
TaQs Weather
TweetMe

E-COMMERCE
iBss
Exclusive Luxe
Scratch

RELIGIOUS & EDU
Afasy
ArabNileGroup

UTILITY & TOOLS
Unlocking Smart
Insta
iContacts
🚀 *First iOS app*

AI & ML
HaramBlur — CoreML
RecognizeMe
🎓 *Grad project — OpenCV*

WEB
FaceDemo
Web Pages

§ 06 Record

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Information Systems

Computer Sciences College
Asyut University, Egypt · 2009–2013
iOS Semester — Excellent (91.5%)

CERTIFICATION

ISTQB Foundation Level

Egyptian Software Testing Qualification Board

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Professional

§ 07 Honours

01 Led an iOS engineering team for **7 consecutive years** on a POS platform serving **20k+ restaurants** and cafés — through the product's growth from launch scale to enterprise.

02 Held a **99.8–99.9% crash-free rate** and cut deployment time **60%** by building the standards, tests and CI/CD the team ran on.

03 **Founded Buraq** (buraqegypt.com), an Egyptian ride-hailing platform, and built all nine repositories solo — backend, ops console, rider and captain apps on iOS and Android, and the public web app, live since Oct 2026 — behind **10,000+ automated tests**.

04 Built a food-delivery platform serving **20M+ users** across Saudi Arabia and Bahrain, and a ride-hailing ecosystem serving **15M+ users** in Saudi Arabia.

05 **10+ apps** published on the App Store, used by millions across MENA.

06 **30+ projects** delivered across a 12-year career.

07 Early Swift adopter (WWDC 2014) and early SwiftUI adopter (WWDC 2019) — a habit of betting on the right platform shift early.

FOUNDER & CTO, BURAQ · BUILDS V1 SOLO · 12+ YEARS · 8+ LEADING

SET IN FRAUNCES & JETBRAINS MONO EDITION 2026 · CAIRO → RIYADH